

The Boston Globe

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FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 11, 2026

Checking Trump’s \$5,000 promise

If it arrives, it’s unlikely to cover your costs

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — If President Trump’s promise Wednesday night to send Americans big checks sounds familiar, it’s because he’s floated ideas like that before.

And based on his track record — as well as the specific condition to his pledge of \$5,000 for every adult US citizen — you might want to hold off on dreams of how you’d spend the money. In fact, in some ways you might have already spent it because of Trump’s other policies.

In his second term, Trump already has failed to deliver on his promise of \$2,000 dividend checks from tariff revenues, replacing Obamacare tax credits with direct payments into health savings accounts, and sending Americans a 20 percent cut of the savings from Elon Musk’s Department of Government Efficiency.

And, none of those came with the major caveat Trump attached to his proposal for \$5,000 checks: Republicans must hold the House and Senate majorities in November’s elections.

“So if the Republicans win, you win with us and you get \$5,000,” Trump declared in a speech at the party’s midterm convention in Dallas. “It will be called the Trump dividend.”

Given Trump’s low approval ratings and the historical trend of the party in the White House losing congressional seats in the midterms, the odds are low Republicans can hold their slim House majority. And, some analysts believe the Democrats also have a legitimate chance to win the Senate majority.

But even if Republicans do manage to defy history and keep control of Congress, the cost of Trump’s plan could be difficult for many lawmakers to swallow after the national debt recently topped \$40 trillion. Congress would have to approve the money for the checks.

Sending \$5,000 checks to approximately 240 million would cost some \$1.2 trillion — significantly more than the roughly

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Tell me sun thing good

Friday: Less humid, becoming sunny.
High: 75-80. Low: 56-61.
Saturday: Sunny and nice.
High: 73-78. Low: 61-66.
Sunrise: 6:20 Sunset: 7:01
Comics and Weather, **G6-7**.
Obituaries, **C9**.

The Trump administration has proposed to no longer count immigrants without green cards in the 2030 census or ask about race and ethnicity. **A2**.

The Iran-backed Houthi rebel group took over Yemen’s port city of Mokha, an area vital to controlling shipping through the Red Sea, Houthi and Yemeni officials said. **A3**.

The state’s highest court issued a formal public reprimand to Judge Shelley Joseph, who was accused of allowing a defendant in Newton District Court to evade immigration agents waiting in the hallway to apprehend him in 2018. **B1**.

A Superior Court judge extended a freeze on eight bank accounts of chef Barbara Lynch, once hailed among Boston’s most influential culinary figures before the collapse of her restaurant empire. **B5**.

VOL. 310, NO. 73

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00



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BY CHRIS SERRES AND BRIAN MACQUARRIE
GLOBE STAFF

On a bright morning in August, Haleema Salie was sorting through boxes of old family photos and papers at her apartment in Framingham when the sight of a 25-year-old ultrasound — and the unmistakable outline of an infant boy — brought her to a sudden stop.

The black-and-white scan showed her unborn grandson at nearly 7 months, his round cheeks and delicate features remarkably clear. For several minutes, Salie sat in silence, eyes welling, imagining the life stolen from him — his first steps, his birthdays, and the young man he would have grown to be.

Salie was swept back to the morning of Sept. 11, 2001. A teacher at a Montessori school in Wellesley, she was escorting children from their parents’ cars into the building, when she overheard colleagues mentioning hijacked

Clockwise from top: Old photos of Rahma Salie and the wedding bands she and her husband, Micky Theodoridis, exchanged. Miles Schlichte Jr. was part of one of the first FEMA teams at Ground Zero. Stephanie Holland at a plaque for her mother, who was killed on 9/11.

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Muslims reflect

In Greater Boston, some are cautiously optimistic about their place in America. **B1**.

At Logan

Airport’s memorial has transformed with grace, writes Murray Whyte. **B1**.

Clancy juror cites key moment

Says video made clear mother’s delusions

By Shelley Murphy
GLOBE STAFF

Midway through deliberations in Lindsay Clancy’s trial for killing her three children, jurors watched a video of her being interviewed in April at Tewksbury Hospital by a psychiatrist and psychologist who were evaluating her for the prosecution.

The video, marked as an exhibit but never played in open court or released publicly, left the impression that Clancy was delusional and did not believe she was doing anything wrong when she killed them in 2023, according to one of the jurors.

“It really made us realize more about altruistic filicide,” said the juror, Paula Devlin, referring to the psychiatric term for a parent who kills a child because of a delusional belief it’s in their best interest. “And it made us realize that whatever she did, however she did it, it came from a place of love.”

Devlin said it convinced her Clancy was in a deep depression, wanted to kill herself, and “in that moment her delusion was, her kids would be better off if she had to be gone, then they had to be gone.”

After watching the video, one of three men on the jury said it made him “step back” from his position that Clancy was guilty of first-degree murder and “at that point he said he didn’t think it was premeditated,” Devlin said during the interview Thursday with the Globe.

Yet, later, according to Devlin, that same juror was the sole holdout against acquittal as the jury voted 11-1 to find Clancy not guilty based on a lack of criminal responsibility, accepting the defense’s claim she was suffering from post-

JUROR, Page A10

Uncertainty surrounds Springfield cyberattack

Officials vow schools will reopen Monday

By Danny McDonald
GLOBE STAFF

SPRINGFIELD — The scene was notable for what was not happening.

At the time when students are normally let out at Springfield Central High School, there were scores of empty spots in the parking lot, no crowds of teenagers streaming out of the sprawling brick complex.

School was most definitely not in, and for a sci-fi-movie-sounding reason: a cyberattack had crippled the district’s ability to function. Officials said they couldn’t access vital and basic IT systems, including email and phones, medical and food databases, among other student information, as well as classroom curriculum, a spokesperson for Mayor Domenic J. Sarno said on Thursday.

At a City Hall news conference on Thursday, officials said school would resume on Monday after what they called a “sophisticated” group of hackers targeted and breached the district’s systems, causing authorities to nix school for an entire week.

“We’re not going to let these SOB’s win,” Sarno told reporters.

Sarno declined to detail how the cyberattack unfolded or who was responsible, saying, “We don’t want to say too much.”

He appeared to allude to a request for money from those responsible for the network attack, saying at one point, “Money goes to our kids, not these individuals,” but he refused to expound on it when pressed, citing the ongoing investigation.

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